# The same device, two documentation strategies

Case study: a Class IIa digital clinical thermometer. Left — the uniform-rigor file that industry practice submits (every document, every class, because nobody dares to cut). Right — the minimal compliant set DocLite derives, with a clause citation for every document removed. All figures computed live by the deterministic engine.

**Class IIa** Digital Clinical Thermometer

EU MDR Annex VIII · Rule 10 (active diagnosis/monitoring) · Notified Body required

THE UNIFORM SUBMISSION — INDUSTRY PRACTICE

**52** documents · ~1,878 h

The full corporate template set, applied identically from stethoscope to implant. Every document drafted, reviewed, approved, maintained on every design change, and defensible at every audit — including the ones the law never asked for.

DOCLITE — THE PROVABLE MINIMUM

**35** required · 962 h

**+9** conditional (188 h) — each with the exact determination to document

**−8** eliminated (728 h) — each with the clause proving it

**~822 hours (44%) saved** — and, more importantly, every omission pre-answered for the auditor.

## THE EXCESS, ITEMIZED — WHAT THE UNIFORM FILE CARRIES FOR NOTHING

| DOCUMENT IN THE UNIFORM SUBMISSION | HOURS | WHY IT WAS NEVER REQUIRED | CITATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| Clinical Investigation (pre-market study) | 400 h | The Art. 61(4) obligation applies only to Class III and implantables — clinical evidence comes from the right-sized clinical evaluation instead | Art. 62 + Annex |
| Software Lifecycle File (IEC 62304) | 100 h | No software in the device — the entire lifecycle set is inapplicable | Annex I §17.2 |
| Sterilization Validation | 60 h | Not supplied sterile | Annex I §11.4 |
| Cybersecurity Documentation | 60 h | No software or connectivity | Annex I §17.4 |

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|---|---|---|---|
| Packaging & Sterile-Barrier Validation (ISO 11607) | 48 h | No sterile barrier system to validate | Annex I §11.4 |
| Summary of Safety & Clinical Performance (SSCP) | 40 h | SSCP applies only to implantables and Class III | Art. 32 |
| PMS Report (Class I form) | 12 h | Class IIa produces a PSUR under Art. 86 instead — the Art. 85 report is the Class I instrument | Art. 85 vs 86 |
| Implant Card & Patient Information | 8 h | Not an implantable device | Art. 18 |
| **Total excess in the uniform submission** | **728 h** | **— plus its lifetime of reviews, updates and audit exposure on every design change** | |

## GROUND TRUTH — A REAL CLEARED SUBMISSION AGREES

| EVIDENCE LAYER | FDA 510(K) K163603 — REAL CLEARED DIGITAL THERMOMETER (2017) | DOCLITE'S VERDICT FOR THE SAME DEVICE | MAT |
|---|---|---|---|
| Biocompatibility | Submitted: ISO 10993-5, ISO 10993-10 (probe contacts mucous membrane) | Required — body-orifice contact triggers ISO 10993-1 evaluation | ✓ |
| Electrical safety & EMC | Submitted: IEC 60601-1, IEC 60601-1-2, IEC 60601-1-11 (home use) | Required — active (powered) device | ✓ |
| Clinical accuracy performance | Submitted: ASTM E1112, ISO 80601-2-56 | Required — measuring function verification (design verification) | ✓ |
| Clinical investigation (human study) | **Absent** — cleared via predicate equivalence, no clinical study | Eliminated — Art. 61(4) applies to III/implantables only | ✓ |
| Sterilization validation | **Absent** — device not sterile | Eliminated — Annex I §11.4 not applicable | ✓ |
| Software lifecycle file (IEC 62304) | **Absent** — no software documentation listed | Eliminated — no software in device | ✓ |
| Cybersecurity documentation | **Absent** — no connectivity | Eliminated — Annex I §17.4 not applicable | ✓ |

The regulator cleared this real thermometer with exactly the testing DocLite marks Required — and **none of the documents DocLite eliminates appear in the cleared file**. Source: FDA K163603 510(k) summary, accessdata.fda.gov (public record).

**Honesty notes:** (1) K163603 is a US 510(k) — its public summary covers the evidence/testing layer, not the full QMS file (FDA inspects QMS separately), so the validation applies to the Product Verification and Clinical scoping specifically. (2) Real EU technical files are confidential, so the EU-side comparison uses the representative uniform-rigor file — the full 52-document regulatory superset — as the ceiling, not a named company's submission. Full-file validation path: pilot back-testing with partner RA teams.